

1950, August 24

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

CAPUCHIN FRANCISCAN
FATHERS

PAX ET BONUM

ST. FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

(seal)

August 24th 1950

Bles'd be God in all His designs.

God bless you I surely do sympathize with you in your manifold troubles. However Saint Paul assures us, for our encouragement no doubt and for our consolation; "Whom the Lord loveth He chasteneth." I have been long since convinced of the inspiration of this saying. ... The fact that Almighty God has permitted so many and such trials and crosses to come your way, till in a way you are forced to seek help where otherwise you would hardly ever dream of turning, indicates to me that the Good God must love you specially. I would wish I might express something of the peace that I hope will come to you as a direct result of your bravely humbling yourself just to appeal as you have done. God bless you for such effort.

After all, I am sure that such reluctance on your part was nothing less than a temptation of the enemy of our souls, to divert you from the path to peace you thereby took, — the path to that peace of which the unbelieving world has hardly any conception; therefore, as Saint Paul says simply: "...which the world can not give. ...which surpasseth all understanding".

As to your not being Catholic: You are probably more so than you imagine, — if you only just knew what Catholicity is. I am confident that you will agree with me when I claim that, whatever we may call ourselves, — you or I, or anyone else, — we are Christians only inasmuch as we believe in Jesus Christ and keep His word, His Commandments. There can be but one Christianity, for there is only one Jesus Christ. Moreover, if we define religion as a science — and who can doubt, if properly studied, that it is the greatest of all sciences, — then there can be but one religion; only one such science. Truly scientific and educated peoples have in all ages understood "the Science of the Saints" to refer to religion, i e, to the relationship between Almighty God and His rational creatures.

(Unfinished draft)